헷갈리는 말: 안/않, 되/돼 바르게 쓰기

Learn two quick tests for spelling 안 or 않 and 되 or 돼 correctly. Koreans often mix these up in messages and notices because they sound almost the same.

WHAT THIS IS FOR

By the end, you can read short messages and notices and spot wrong uses of 안/않 and 되/돼. You can also correct them using the 하/해 test and the -지 test.

1 SAME SOUND, DIFFERENT SPELLING

In speech, 되 and 돼 sound almost the same, and 않아요 sounds like [아나요]. Because of this, even native speakers often mix them up in chats and online comments. It is a bit like your/you're in English.

In a casual chat, a mistake like this is easy to forgive. In a work email, a notice, or a test, it looks careless, so it is worth checking before you send.

2 TWO QUICK TESTS

되/돼 (the 하/해 test): Put 하 or 해 in the same spot. If 해 sounds right, write 돼 (해요 → 돼요, 했어요 → 됐어요, 해서 → 돼서). If 하 sounds right, write 되 (하면 → 되면, 하는 → 되는, 하고 → 되고). Remember: 돼 is just 되어 made shorter.

안/않 (the -지 test): If the word comes after -지 and has an ending (-아요, -고, -으면, -은), write 않. If it stands alone right before a verb or adjective, write 안 and put a space after it.

3 WORDS AND PATTERNS

1	**안 + verb** (not (short form))	안 goes right before the verb and is always written as a separate word. 예: 오늘은 술을 안 마셔요.
2	**-지 않아요** (do not (long form))	않 always comes after -지 and always takes an ending. 예: 이 김치는 맵지 않아요.
3	**-지 않고** (without doing)	Use it when you did one thing without doing another. 예: 아침을 먹지 않고 학교에 왔어요.
4	**-지 않으면** (if (you) don't)	Use it for a condition: if you don't do something. 예: 지금 출발하지 않으면 늦어요.
5	**돼요** (it's OK / becomes)	This is 되어요 made shorter, so never write 되요. 예: 카드로 계산해도 돼요?
6	**됐어요** (it's ready / done)	This is the past form, from 되었어요. 예: 밥 다 됐어요. 와서 드세요.
7	**되면** (if it becomes / if it works out)	Before -면, keep 되 (the test word is 하면). 예: 시간이 되면 같이 가요.
8	**되는** (that works / that has)	Before -는, keep 되 (the test word is 하는). 예: 와이파이 되는 카페 알아요?

Copyright © 2026 DURU KOREAN. All rights reserved.
For personal and educational use only. Commercial use, redistribution, or reproduction without the author's permission is prohibited.

9	**돼서** (because (I) became)	This is 되어서 made shorter (the test word is 해서). 예: 회사원이 돼서 요즘 바빠요.
10	**안 돼요** (not allowed / doesn't work)	This is 안 + 돼요, written as two words. 예: 여기서 담배 피우면 안 돼요.

The messages and notice in this worksheet are made-up examples for practice.

4 YOUR TURN

SPELL IT RIGHT

Use the 하/해 test and the -지 test to choose, fix, or write the correct form.

1 Choose the correct form:
①제 동생은 올해 대학생이 (되요 / 돼요).
②그 가게는 일요일에 문을 열지 (안아요 / 않아요).
③이 노트북은 인터넷이 잘 (안 돼요 / 않 돼요).

2 Fill in each blank with 되 or 돼:
①회의 준비가 다 ____면 알려 주세요.
②제 꿈은 의사가 ____는 거예요.
③길이 막혀서 약속에 늦게 ____서 미안해요.

3 Write O if the spelling is correct and X if it is wrong:
①이번 주말에는 시간이 안 돼요.
②그 영화는 별로 재미있지 않았어요.
③여기에 주차하면 안되요.
④저는 고기를 않 먹어요.

4 Read the notice and correct the two spelling mistakes:
[안내] 이번 주 금요일에는 수업이 없어요. 숙제는 월요일까지 내면 되요. 월요일까지 내지 안으면 점수를 받을 수 없어요.

5 Answer with -지 않아요:
①커피 자주 마셔요?
②그 신발 불편해요?

ANSWERS

1) ① 돼요 ② 않아요 ③ 안 돼요
2) ① 되 (되면) ② 되 (되는) ③ 돼 (돼서)
3) ① O ② O ③ X (안 돼요) ④ X (안 먹어요)
4) 되요 → 돼요, 안으면 → 않으면
5) ① 아니요, (커피) 자주 마시지 않아요. ② 아니요, 불편하지 않아요.

Copyright © 2026 DURU KOREAN. All rights reserved.
For personal and educational use only. Commercial use, redistribution, or reproduction without the author's permission is prohibited.